

ANTS, BEES, AND WASPS

These groups of insects include many that sting. Ants and nearly all types of bees and wasps live in organized colonies.



WOOD ANT



ARMY ANT



COMMON WASP



ASIAN CARPENTER BEE



TAWNY MINING BEE

FLIES

There are thousands of species of flies around the world. Although some types are disease-carrying pests, many are useful as pollinators of plants.



BLUEBOTTLE



TIMBER FLY



HOUSE FLY



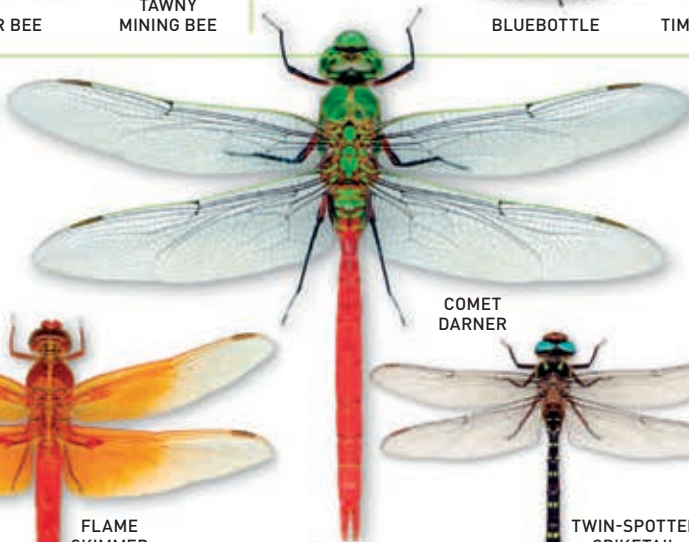
GIANT BLUE ROBBER FLY

DRAGONFLIES AND DAMSELFLIES

Slender bodies and large wings make these the flying aces of the insect world. They are skilful predators, darting through the air to catch other insects.



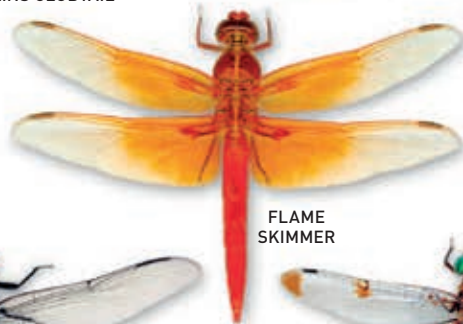
PLAINS CLUBTAIL



COMET DARTER



MEDITERRANEAN DAMSELFLY



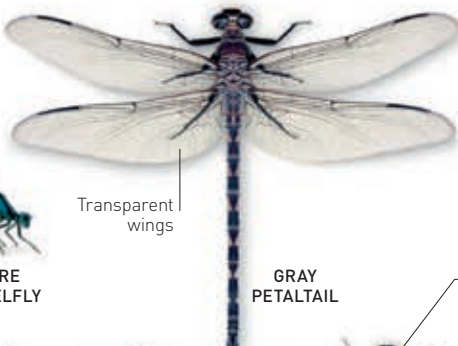
FLAME SKIMMER



TWIN-SPOTTED SPIKETAIL



AZURE DAMSELFLY



GRAY PETALTAIL



EMPEROR DRAGONFLY



SOUTHERN HAWKER DRAGONFLY



ILLINOIS RIVER CRUISER



BANDED DEMOISELLE



GIANT HAWKER



BROAD-BODIED CHASER



WHITE-LEGGED DAMSELFLY

BUTTERFLIES AND MOTHS

Often colourful, butterflies are daytime flyers. Moths are usually duller and most fly at night. Both have tiny scales on their wings.



ORANGE OAKLEAF BUTTERFLY



MONARCH BUTTERFLY



GARDEN TIGER MOTH



MADAGASCAN SUNSET MOTH

LIFECYCLE

All insects start life as an egg. Once they hatch out, their bodies go through changes as they grow into adults. The lifecycle of the ladybird, shown here, is how many beetles develop.



1 EGGS

The female may lay hundreds of eggs over the spring and early summer.



2 LARVA

Each egg hatches into a larva (young, undeveloped insect).



3 SKIN CHANGES

The larva eats and grows, shedding its skin multiple times over several weeks.



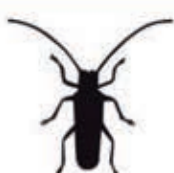
4 PUPA

When the larva is full size, its skin splits to reveal the pupa (non-feeding stage).



5 ADULT

Inside a tight wrapping, the pupa changes, and an adult ladybird emerges.



TITAN LONGHORN BEETLE
16.7 CM (6.5 IN)



FAIRYFLY
0.139 MM (0.005 IN)

BIGGEST AND SMALLEST

One of the largest insects in the world is the South American Titan Longhorn Beetle, which can fill the palm of a hand. The tiniest insects are fairyflies, barely visible without a magnifying glass.

ALL-ROUND VISION

Insects have compound eyes. While a human eye has one lens, a compound eye has hundreds or thousands of lenses. This allows insects to look in many directions at once.

HORSEFLY



Large compound eyes are very sensitive to movement